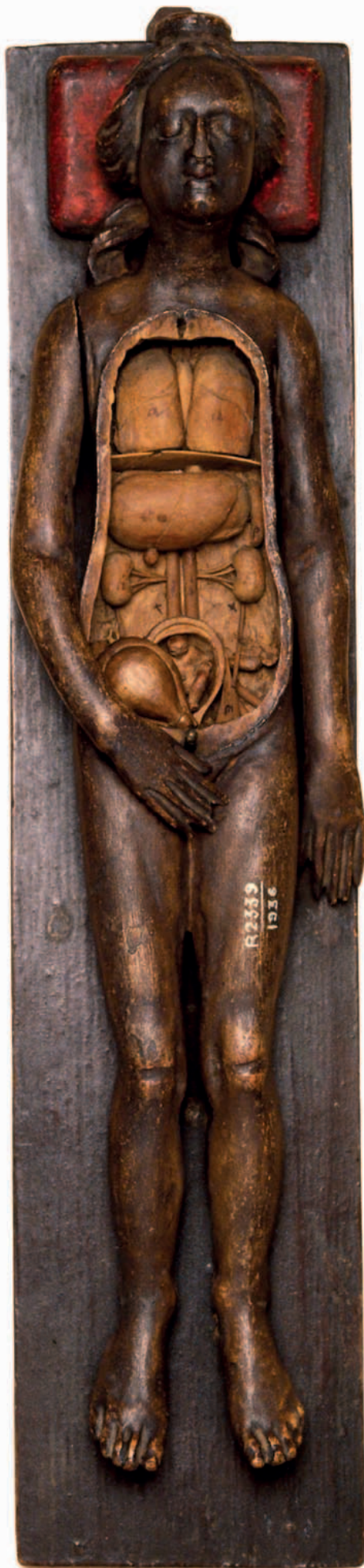




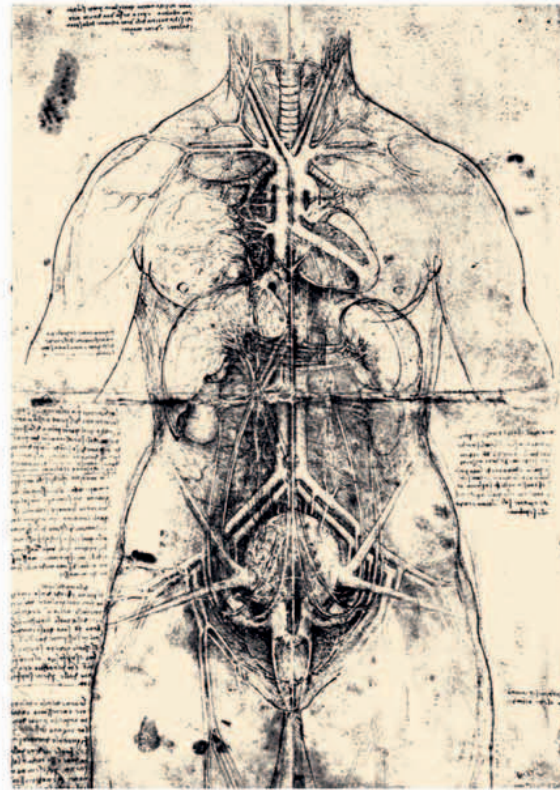
MEDIEVAL THINKING

In early medieval times, knowledge about the workings of the human body was still largely based on many of Galen's theories. It was not until the 1400s, when laws on dissecting corpses were relaxed in some countries, that anatomists could study the body and try to find out how the bones, muscles, and body systems worked.

◀ **TEACHING ANATOMY** *During the 1400s, wooden anatomical models, such as the ones show here, were used as medical teaching aids.*

WOW!

Body snatching—digging up and stealing dead bodies from graves for medical students to dissect—was widespread in some countries from about 1750 to 1850.



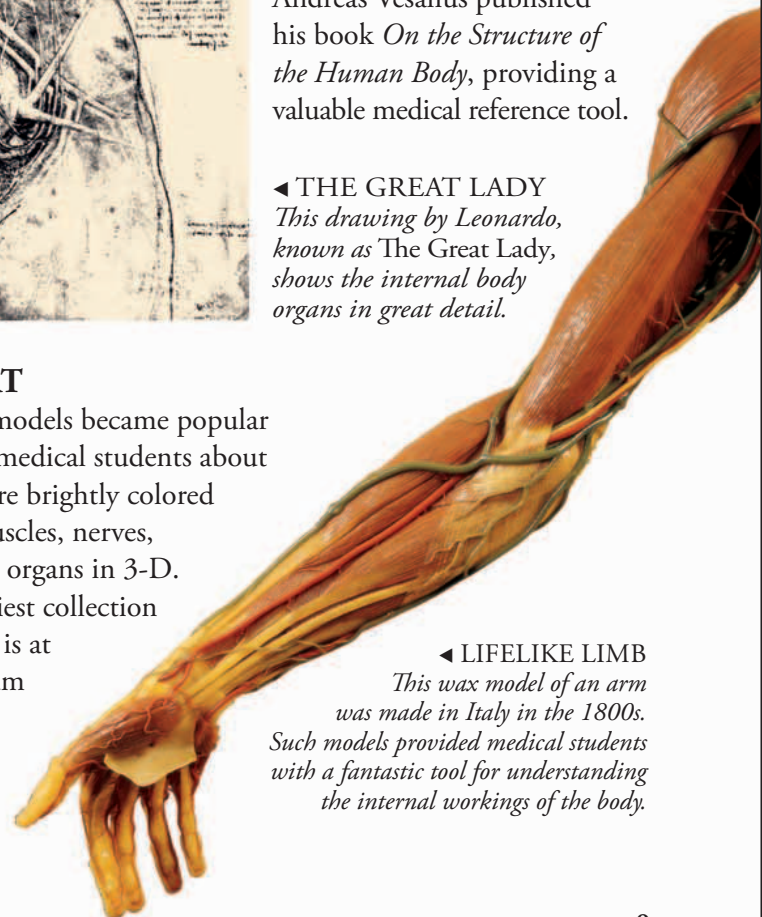
BODY ART

In the late 1400s, when Italian artist Leonardo da Vinci was given permission to dissect corpses, he used his skill to draw many anatomically precise pictures. But in an age when the printing press was still a new invention, Leonardo's drawings remained unseen. The breakthrough came in 1543, when Flemish doctor Andreas Vesalius published his book *On the Structure of the Human Body*, providing a valuable medical reference tool.

◀ **THE GREAT LADY** *This drawing by Leonardo, known as The Great Lady, shows the internal body organs in great detail.*

WAXWORKS OF ART

Detailed anatomical wax models became popular in the 1700s for teaching medical students about the human body. They were brightly colored and clearly showed the muscles, nerves, blood vessels, and internal organs in 3-D. The most famous and earliest collection of anatomical wax models is at the oldest scientific museum in Europe, La Specola in Florence, Italy.



◀ **LIFELIKE LIMB** *This wax model of an arm was made in Italy in the 1800s. Such models provided medical students with a fantastic tool for understanding the internal workings of the body.*

